



## Storey — product strategy

*Captured 2026-05-22, the day after the 12-tester gate cleared.*

*Strategic positioning decisions, not feature spec. Things that affect who Storey sells to, how it positions itself, and what the long-term shape of the company looks like. Update when reality changes the assumptions.*

### The current positioning (locked, May 2026)

*Storey is a site-operations app for construction contractors in Northeast India.*

- **Buyer:** the main contractor (or owner-operator of a contracting firm)
- **Operator:** the supervisor + site\_manager on the contractor's payroll
- **Sub-contractors:** *entities* in the contractor's workflow — tracked, paid, given Work Orders, but not logged into Storey themselves (Path A, decided 2026-05-20)
- **Region:** NE India first, then adjacent geographies (Eastern UP, Bihar, Jharkhand, Odisha at 365-day horizon)
- **Tally is the trust benchmark** — not the feature benchmark. Storey beats Tally on operations + data ownership; Tally still owns the books.

### The dual-market insight (2026-05-22)

**Sub-contractors can also be customers of Storey, not just entities.**

A small electrical contractor running 3 simultaneous wiring jobs has the same daily ops pain as a main contractor running 3 sites — workers to track, material to allocate, expenses to log, photos to document. Storey's data model already supports him without any code change — he's just a "tenant" with sites that happen to be smaller scopes.

## The market math

|                          | Main contractors in NE India   | Sub-contractors / specialist trades    |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Approximate count        | ~5,000–10,000                  | ~50,000–100,000                        |
| Daily ops pain           | High (multi-site, multi-trade) | High (multi-job, multi-worker)         |
| Willingness to pay       | Higher (₹2–5k/month/site)      | Lower (₹300–1k/month)                  |
| Decision speed           | Slow (committee, partner)      | Faster (single owner-operator)         |
| Storey product fit today | Strong                         | Strong — just a smaller-scale instance |

**10× more sub-contractors than main contractors.** Lower individual ARPU, but volume + faster sales cycles compensate. Plus referrals: every sub-contractor on Storey is a recommendation node for their main contractor

- their trade peers.

## What this means for positioning

Tagline evolves from:

*"Storey: site-operations app for construction contractors in NE India."*

to:

*"Storey: site-operations app for everyone running construction work in NE India — from 50-site main contractors to specialist trades managing their own jobs."*

## What this requires in code

**Almost nothing.** Multi-tenancy already supports any tenant at any scale.

| Feature                            | Main contractor uses it as... | Sub-contractor uses it as...                       |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| <code>tenants</code> table         | Their construction firm       | Their specialist trade firm                        |
| <code>sites</code>                 | Each construction project     | Each job (could be "Mr Sharma's 5th-floor wiring") |
| <code>workers</code>               | Their labour roster           | Their helpers                                      |
| <code>materials</code>             | Steel, cement, etc.           | Wires, conduit, switches                           |
| <code>expenses</code>              | Site expenses                 | Site expenses                                      |
| <code>tasks</code>                 | Construction phases           | Wiring phases (DBs · main runs · finishing)        |
| <code>subcontractors</code> (v1.2) | Their hired specialists       | Their hired sub-sub-contractors                    |

Same fields, smaller numbers. Storey doesn't care about scale.

## What this requires in marketing

1. **Landing page subhead** — broaden from *"for construction contractors"* to *"for anyone running construction work — big or small."*
2. **Beta poster v2** — add a one-line callout: *"Are you an electrician / plumber / mason running your own jobs? Storey works for you too."*
3. **Sub-contractor onboarding flow inside Storey becomes a soft recruitment funnel** — when a main contractor adds "Mistri Ramesh" with his WhatsApp number, Ramesh (opt-in, not automatic) later gets a one-line WhatsApp from Storey: *"Karun added you to a project on Storey. Want your own free Storey account to track your own jobs?"*

That last point is the **viral loop** — ride the main contractor's adoption as a recruitment channel for the 10× sub-contractor population.

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## Pricing tier framework (*when MRR justifies, not now*)

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A natural 2-tier model emerges from the dual-market insight:

Storey Solo — single-site, single-tenant

₹500/month

For specialist trades, single sub-contractors, micro-firms

Self-onboard, minimal support

Upgrade path → Storey Pro when adding the 2nd site

Storey Pro — multi-site, multi-user, full features

₹2,000–5,000/month per site (volume discount at >5 sites)

For main contractors with site teams

Manual onboarding, dedicated support, advisory call quarterly

Storey Enterprise — for the future

Custom pricing (₹50k+/month, multi-year)

For tier-2 builders, govt-tied work, large project consortia

Dedicated DB, premium support, custom reporting

Discussed but parked until 50+ paying customers signal the need

**Don't introduce tiers yet.** Single price for v1.2 testers. Tiering becomes a Phase 3 (Day 60–90) decision per ROADMAP-90.md.

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## Why dual-marketing is Option C (*not A or B*)

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Three strategic options were considered 2026-05-22:

| Option                                             | Description                                                                                                                | Verdict                     |
|----------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>A</b> — Same product, ignore the new audience   | Status quo. Sub-contractors stay as entities only. Leaves 10× audience on the table.                                       | ✗ Misses a big upside       |
| <b>B</b> — Two separate product lines (Pro + Lite) | Different marketing, channels, pricing. Maintains TWO products = solo-founder death by feature divergence.                 | ✗ Operational risk too high |
| <b>C</b> — Same product, dual marketing posture    | Storey is one product that markets to anyone running construction site work. Each customer is a tenant at their own scale. | ✓ Recommended               |

Option C wins because:

- **Zero code divergence** — same product, broader pitch
- **Natural upgrade path** — sub-contractors graduate to Pro tier as they add sites
- **Viral mechanic built in** — every sub-contractor on Storey is a node introducing the main contractor (or vice versa) into the network
- **No channel conflict** — both audiences are using the same product; if the main contractor sees his electrician is on Storey, that's *validation*, not threat

## What's deliberately deferred

These ideas are real but wrong-timing right now:

| Decision                              | Defer until...                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Landing page rewrite to broaden pitch | 5 paying main contractors validate current positioning first                                                                                 |
| Sub-contractor self-signup flow       | After v1.2 ships (the entity model is settled)                                                                                               |
| Tier pricing introduction             | Day 60-90 (per ROADMAP-90.md Phase 3)                                                                                                        |
| Viral WhatsApp recruitment            | After 12 testers cleared ( <i>done 2026-05-21</i> ) + v1.2 ships ( <i>planned ~Day 60</i> ) — needs the onboarding flow to be polished first |
| Enterprise tier                       | After 50+ paying customers signal demand                                                                                                     |

## How to know when these decisions are wrong

Update this doc when any of these data points shift:

| Signal                                                                   | What it means                                           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 5+ paying main contractors say <i>"this is too feature-heavy for me"</i> | Solo tier is needed sooner than expected                |
| First sub-contractor self-signs up unprompted                            | Soft validation of dual-market thesis                   |
| Main contractor complains <i>"my electrician is also on this"</i>        | Channel conflict is real — needs a positioning answer   |
| Adjacent geography (Bihar / UP / Odisha) customer signs up cold          | Geographic expansion possible earlier than 365-day plan |
| Tally adds operational features (workers / materials / sites)            | Real competitive threat — need to defend the wedge      |
| First "I want to install Storey on my own server" with serious money     | Enterprise tier becomes urgent, not deferred            |